



ER Timer Handbook

Running a game: timer, hints & player screens

Version 2.1.14

Covers only the controls you can use without the Manager password. Setup options behind Manager Mode are intentionally not included.

Contents

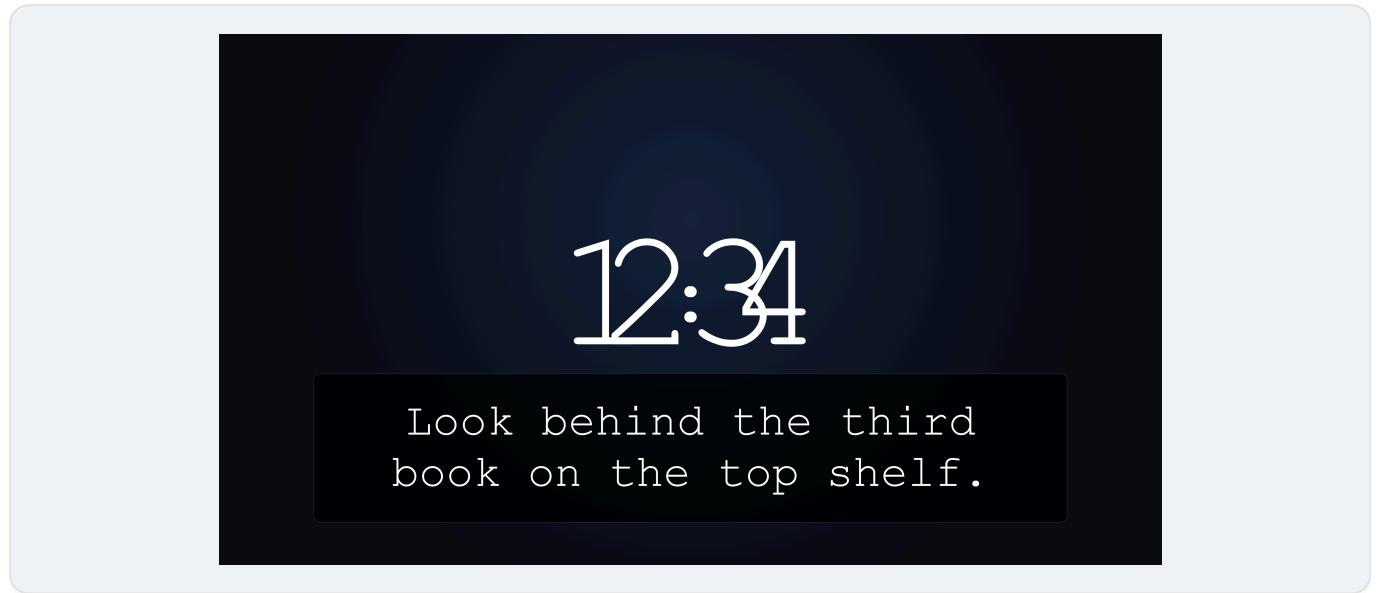
1	Windows & Always-on-Top	
2	Minimize to Icon Button	
3	The Timer	
4	One or Two Rooms	
5	Fullscreen	
6	Text Hints	
7	Hint Sound	
8	Picture Hints	
9	Updating the App	
10	Manager Mode	

1 Windows & Always-on-Top

ER Timer uses two kinds of window.

- **Control window** - the panel you operate (timer and hints).
- **Player window** - the large clock your players see, one per room (shown below).

The Control window is **always-on-top**: it stays above other programs, so clicking another app (a browser, music player, etc.) never hides or buries it.



The player window: large countdown with a hint banner underneath.

Closing the Control window shuts down the whole app, including the player screen(s).

2 Minimize to Icon Button FEATURE

Tuck the panel away without losing it - and without it dropping behind other windows.

- 1 Click the window's **minimize** button. The Control window disappears.
- 2 A small **floating icon button** (desktop-shortcut sized, showing the ER Timer icon) appears in the **bottom-right corner** of your main screen.
- 3 That button **always stays on top** of every other program, so you can always find it.
- 4 **Click the icon button** and the Control window reopens at the exact same size and position as before.



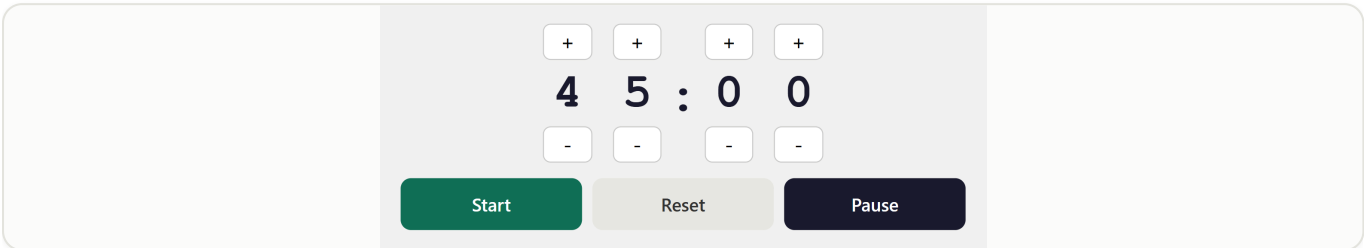
The floating icon button shown over the desktop.

Good to know: while minimized, the clock keeps running and players still see their time - only your control panel is hidden. The button has no taskbar entry.

3 The Timer

A four-digit MM:SS clock, shown on the player screen.

Each digit has a  above it and a  below it - tap them to dial in minutes and seconds before you start.



Digit steppers and the Start / Reset / Pause buttons.

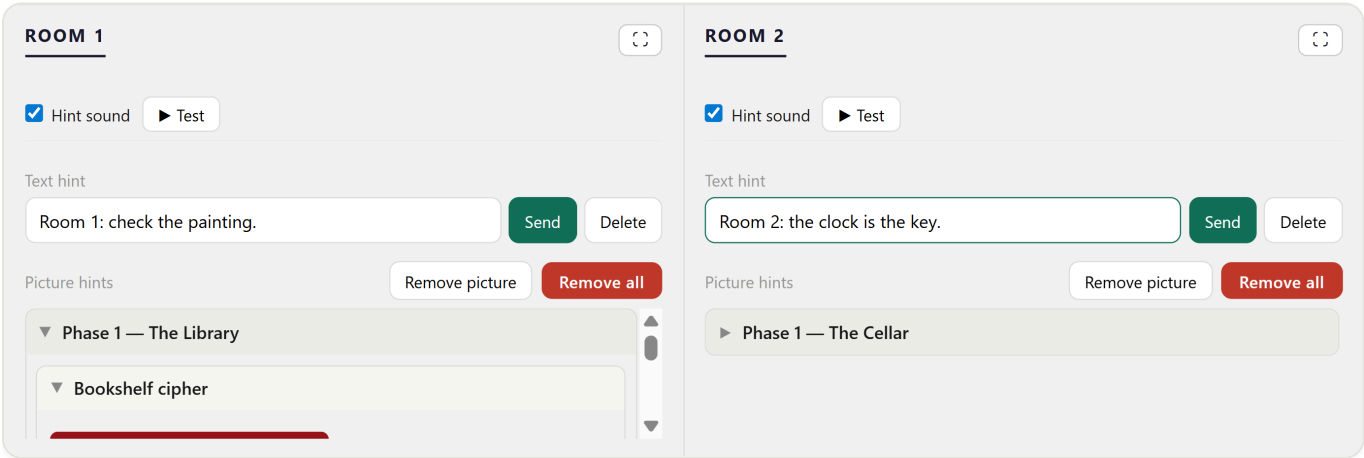
Button	What it does
	Begins counting down from the set time.
	Freezes the clock; press Start to resume.
	Stops and returns to the default start time.

The clock runs in the app's core process, so it keeps **perfect time even when minimized** or when other windows are busy.

4 One or Two Rooms

Run a single room, or two rooms side by side.

- The  checkbox turns the second room (and its player screen) on or off.
- With two rooms on, each room has its own column - text hint, hint sound and picture hints - working independently.

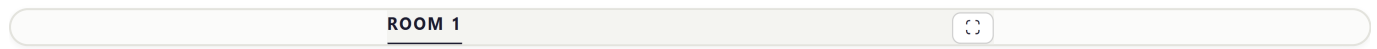


Two-room view: each room is controlled separately.

5 Fullscreen

Each room's player screen can be windowed or full screen.

Click the  button at the top of a room's column to toggle that room's **player window** in and out of full screen.



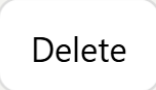
The fullscreen toggle sits beside the room name.

6 Text Hints

Send a written clue to the player screen.

- 1 Type your clue in the **"Type a hint..."** box.
- 2 Click  (or press **Enter**) to show it on that room's player screen.
- 3 Click  to clear the text hint and empty the box.

Text hint

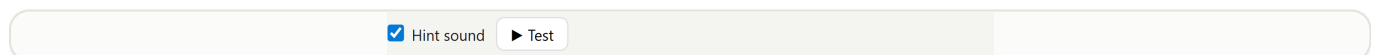


Type a clue, then Send it to the players.

7 Hint Sound

An optional sound that plays on the player screen when you send a hint.

- The **Hint sound** checkbox (per room) turns that sound on or off.
-  plays the sound once so you can check it.



Per-room hint-sound toggle and Test button.

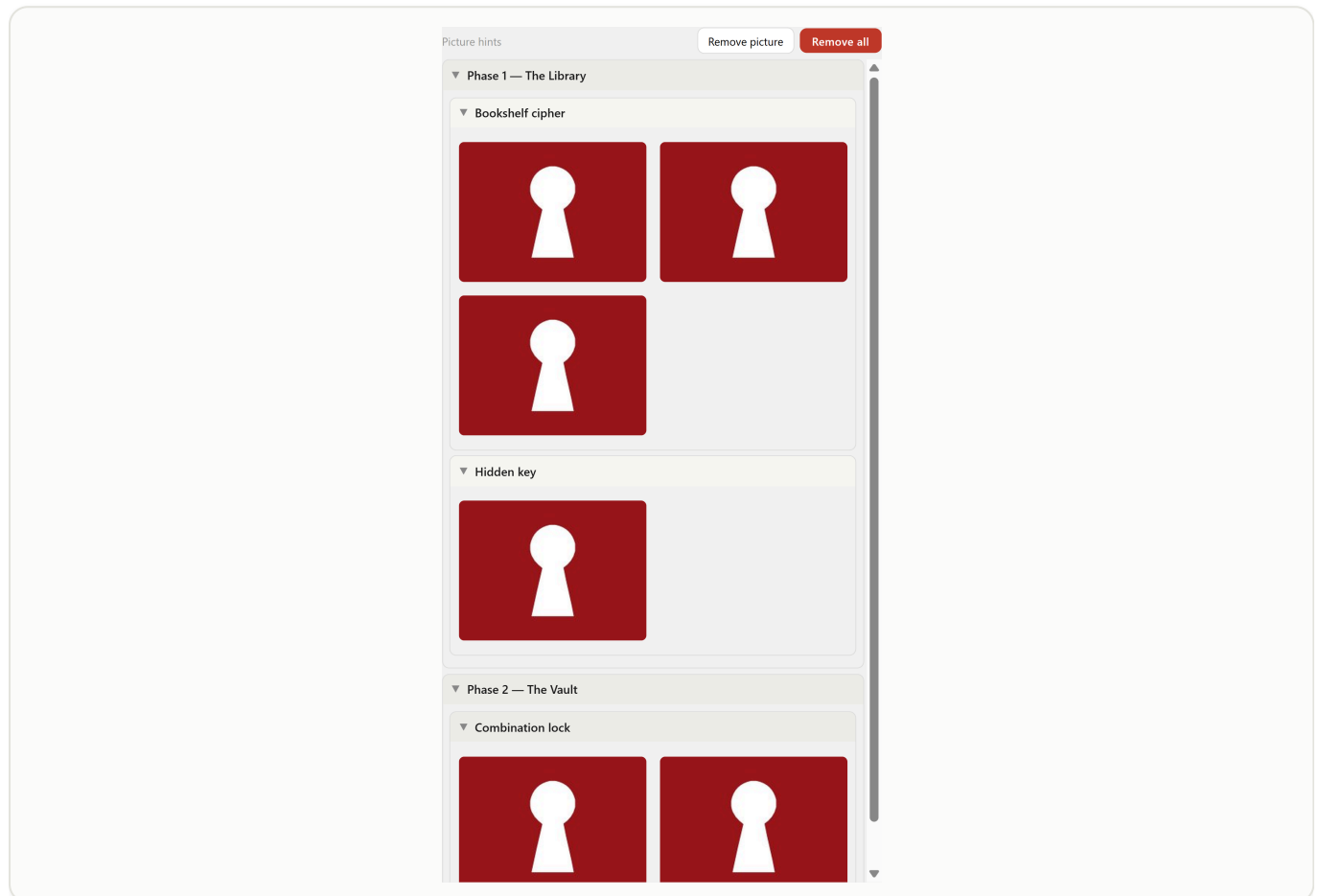
Which sound file is used is chosen in the password-protected Manager area.

8 Picture Hints

Push a prepared picture to the player screen with a single click.

Picture hints are organised into **Phases**; each phase contains **Riddles**; each riddle contains one or more **images**. (This library is prepared in advance in Manager Mode.)

- 1 Click a **Phase** to expand it, then a **Riddle** to reveal its images.
- 2 Click an **image** - it appears on the player screen at once, and the chosen thumbnail is highlighted.
- 3 Click a different image to switch; the new one replaces the old.



Phases → Riddles → images. The highlighted thumbnail is live on screen.

Button	What it does
Remove picture	Takes the current image off the player screen (any text hint stays).
Remove all	Clears both the text hint and the image for that room at once.

Images only. Picture hints accept still images - PNG, JPG, GIF, WEBP, BMP. There is no video hint; an **animated GIF** is the closest motion option.

9 Updating the App

ER Timer checks for updates on its own. **Game Masters should always install updates.**

When a new version is found, a message box appears:

- 1 A dialog says "**ER Timer vX.Y.Z is available. Download now?**" - click **Yes, Download**.
- 2 The download runs in the background; a small bar at the bottom shows the progress.
- 3 When it finishes, a dialog says "**Update downloaded. Restart now to install?**" - click **Restart Now**.
- 4 The app restarts on the new version. Done.



The download-progress bar at the bottom of the Control window.

Always update. Pick **Yes, Download** and then **Restart Now** as soon as you can - ideally between games, never mid-game. If you choose **Later**, the update installs automatically the next time you close the app.

10 Manager Mode

The **Manager Mode** button opens a password-protected area for one-time setup.



The Settings header, with the Manager Mode lock and the 2 Rooms toggle.

Everything behind that password is **intentionally not covered in this handbook** - this guide is only about the controls you use while running a game.